

Q: Who do you view as your competitors, and which cities in India are you targeting with your range of smartphones?

I think the market is big enough and everyone participating in this eco-system is competition of some sort. So it would be difficult to name any particular brand as a competitor. However, from Lenovo's standpoint, we aim to occupy one of the top three positions in the smartphone category. We have the legacy of Lenovo as an already established brand in the PC segment.

Q: The after-sales service of your smartphones has been questioned. Do you recognise this issue and how do you plan to handle it?

Of course, we recognise such things. Every feedback from our consumers, either good or bad, is definitely valuable for us and we take it as a step towards improvement. We have a full-fledged customer service organisation and we also have HCL as our customer service partner. Currently, our footprint is in over 110 towns across the country. So we have a very robust network, which helps us serve our customers better. We have enough capacity and the desired infrastructure to take care of the devices.

Q: A majority of the data usage these days is through the tablets and smartphones. Do you also bundle your devices with data plans from telecom service providers?

What we have noticed is that operators do not participate very actively in handset bundling. But having said that, we are currently tied-up with Reliance, where we will jointly promote our handsets and Reliance's data plans.

Q: Is there a specific segment of people you are targeting with your high-end smartphones?

This is the set of customers who do not wait for an occasion to buy a device. They go by what is the latest technology in the market and the brand that they can associate with. Keeping in mind this behaviour, we are targeting people looking for the latest technologies and want a brand that offers them value for their money.

Lenovo K900 is one of the smartphones that offers a combination of great technology with a reliable brand value. Also, in our P series or the Professional Series, we have a product called P 780. It caters to the metro-based high-end consumers. The device has a large battery, which is an important criterion for such consumers. The phone comes with 4000 mAh battery, which is fairly good for the kind of usage they are looking for. This is also one of the biggest problems in the modern smartphone era, where usage is so high that the batteries cannot sustain it. So, Lenovo has taken care of that feature and it is possibly one of the most unique propositions for our devices. This makes our products a great offering for people who have a 24x7 kind of a lifestyle. The other thing that a high-end consumer looks

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at is the bigger fashion value that their devices come with. They want larger screens, a higher entertainment value and a good camera. That is how we identify and target the high-end consumers.

Q: Quite a few online surveys, particularly done on the Indian market, state that Lenovo doesn't feature among the top five. How are you handling this?

On the contrary, the latest IDC report states that Lenovo is now globally No 4 as far as smartphones is concerned. In India, we have barely started out. It's just three to four months since we have ventured in the Indian market. So, we are gearing up to face the competition. If we talk about the global market, a large part of our market share comes from China, which is one of the largest smartphone markets in the world. So we are already No 4 globally and we are growing very fast. Our strategy is very clear—that we want to be one of the top players in the smart connect devices segment. The journey so far has been rapid, and I think consumers know and understand what to expect from Lenovo.

Q: How has Lenovo K900 been doing in the market?

I cannot share the numbers but I can tell you, from some of the internal data that we have, that we are already occupying a double digit share in the high-end premium segment. The response from our consumers has been extremely good. The best part of the device is that it allows smooth multi-tasking and offers more value for money.

Q: Is there a reason for choosing the Android platform?

The biggest reason for banking on Android is because of the ecosystem that the platform enjoys. Android is arguably the best mobile operating system and users across the globe like it for various reasons. Android offers an easy experience to the consumers, keeping its unique features intact. Also, the app ecosystem of Android is something that lures the consumers. An OEM doesn't need to create a separate app store if it is resorting to Android for its mobile devices. So Android was the obvious choice for Lenovo smartphones. **END** 